

A GIFT OF FIRE THIRD EDITION - SARA BAASE

CHAPTER 2: PRIVACY

Lecture 3

"DIVERSE PRIVACY TOPICS "

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Marketing, Personalization and Consumer

- Targeted and personalized marketing (business, political parties, etc)
- Paying for consumer information Examples -
 - Targeting ads to users by scanning their emails! Like Gmail.
- Data firms and consumer profiles
 - Companies (firms) that collect information about individuals
 - These firms sell data to other companies for marketing purposes.
- Data mining is being used
- Credit records might be sold to different parties

Social Networks

- ❑ What we do
 - Post opinions, gossip, pictures, “away from home” status
- ❑ What they do
 - New services with unexpected privacy settings

Location Tracking:

- ❑ Global Positioning Systems (GPS) -
 - computer or communication services that know exactly where a person is at a particular time
- ❑ Cell phones and other devices are used for location tracking

Stolen and Lost Data:

- ❑ Hackers
- ❑ Physical theft (laptops, thumb-drives, etc.)
- ❑ Requesting information under false pretenses
- ❑ Bribery of employees who have access

What We Do Ourselves

- ❑ Some people do not know or understand enough how the web works in order to make good decisions about what to put there.
- ❑ Some people do not think carefully.
- ❑ People often want a lot of information about others but do not want others to have access to the same kind of information about themselves.
- ❑ Our cell phone and email messages reside on computers outside our home or office.
- ❑ We have no direct control over such files.

What We Do Ourselves

- ❑ There have been many incidents of exposure of emails for politicians, businessmen, etc
- ❑ Personal information in blogs and online profiles
- ❑ Pictures of ourselves and our families
- ❑ File sharing and storing
- ❑ Is privacy old-fashioned?
 - Young people put less value on privacy than previous generations.
 - May not understand the risks.

Public Records: Access vs. Privacy:

- Public Records -
 - Governments maintain “public records,”
 - Records available to general public (bankruptcy, property, and arrest records, salaries of government employees, etc.)
- Identity theft can arise when public records are accessed.
- How should we control access to sensitive public records?

Children (privacy and safety)

- The Internet
 - Not able to make decisions on when to provide information
 - Vulnerable to online predators
- Parental monitoring
 - Software to monitor Web usage
 - Web cams to monitor children while parents are at work
 - GPS tracking via cell phones or RFID

Children (privacy and safety)

- At what age does web monitoring become an invasion of the child's privacy?
- Should parents tell children about the tracking devices and services they are using?
- Informed consent is a basic principle for adults.
- At what age does it apply to children? Will intense tracking and monitoring slow the development of a child's responsible independence? Will parents rely more on gadgets than on talking to their children?

National ID System:

- Social Security Numbers
 - Too widely used
 - Easy to falsify
- A new national ID system - Pros
 - would require the card
 - harder to forge
 - have to carry only one card
- A new national ID system - Cons
 - Threat to freedom and privacy
 - Increased potential for abuse

Thank You